

Foreword

Dave Ramsey

Have you ever done something you *thought* would work, but then it blew you away by exactly *how well* it worked? I'm talking about something that made such a huge impact that you were simultaneously shocked and proven right. I have. In 1994, I started teaching a little local money class called *Financial Peace University* (FPU). It was a labor of love for me. I had recently experienced a massive financial crash and getting out of that mess led me to a whole new way of handling money—an approach rooted in common sense, down-home wisdom, and biblical principles. I taught people the basics, things like saving, budgeting, and getting out of debt. But I also taught them how to invest and start planning for a radically different future. More than five million people have been through that class in the past twenty-five years, and, looking back on what we've seen from those families, I feel both vindicated and frustrated.

I feel vindicated because, as it turns out, God's ways of managing money actually work. People who went through the class and learned the principles from our books and radio show got out of debt. They got their lives under control. They started investing into their 401(k) and other retirement plans. They paid off their homes. And—*surprise*—they built wealth. As we continued to talk to and work with these people, we discovered they hadn't just gotten out of debt, but they had become millionaires! They had experienced a complete transformation in their finances, and they changed the entire trajectory of their families' lives. This stuff works!

However, I also felt frustrated. People were surprised that these millionaires started popping up. Even though we had talked about it for a